Table 7.7 The cellular composition of adult human blood

Cell type	Number of cells per µl	Approximate percentage
Red blood cells	4200,000 - 6500,000	-
White blood cells		
Agranulocytes		
Lymphocytes	1500 - 4000	20-30
Monocytes	200 - 950	2-7
Granulocytes		
Neutrophils	2000-7000	50-70
Basophils	50-100	<1
Eosinophils	40-500	2-5
Platelets	150,000-500,000	-

Lymphocytes

About 20-30% of the white blood cells are lymphocytes. They have a large nucleus filling most of the cell, surrounded by a little cytoplasm. The two main types of lymphocytes are B and T lymphocytes. Both these are produced in the bone marrow. B lymphocytes (B cells) stay in the bone marrow until they are mature. Then they circulate around the body. Some remain in the blood, while others accumulate in the lymph nodes and spleen. T lymphocytes leave the bone marrow and mature in the thymus gland. Once mature, T cells also accumulate in the same areas of the body as B cells. Lymphocytes have receptor proteins on their surface. When receptors on a B cell bind with an antigen, the B cell becomes activated and divides rapidly to produce plasma cells. The plasma cells produce antibodies. Some B cells do not produce antibodies but become memory cells. These cells are responsible for secondary immune response. T lymphocytes do not produce antibodies. They recognize antigen-presenting cells and destroy them. The two important types of T cells are Helper T cells and Killer T cells. Helper T cells release a chemical

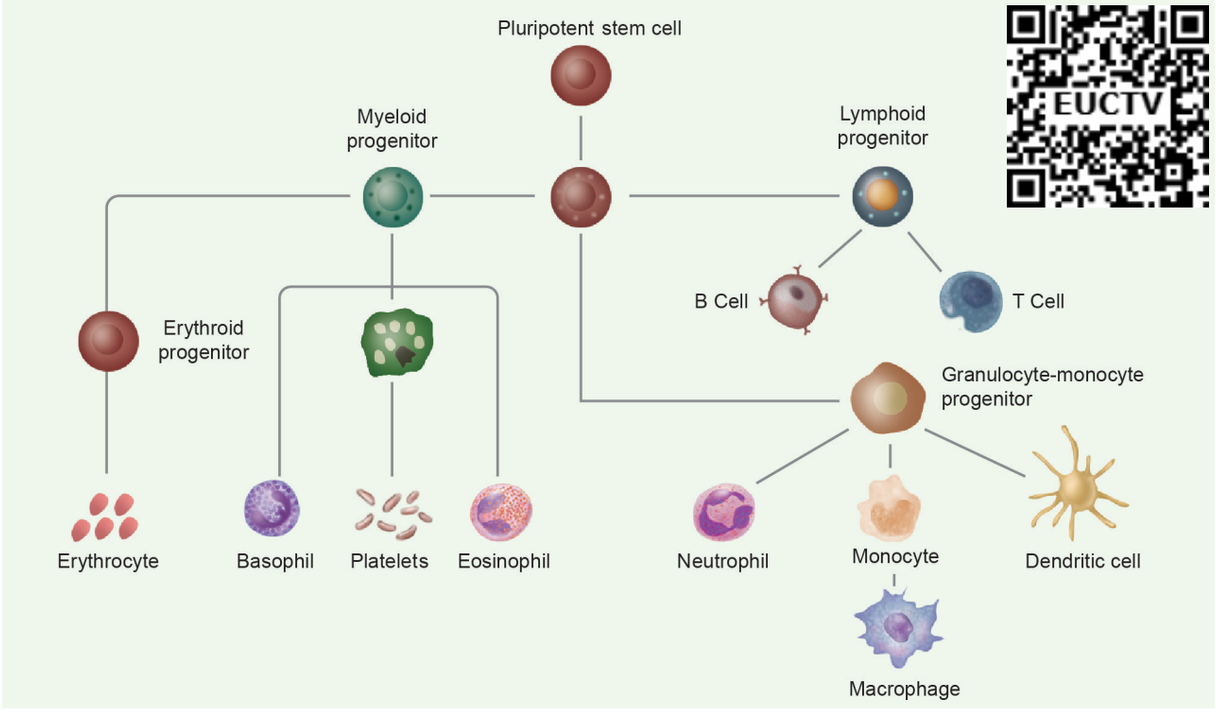


Fig. 7.14 Cells of the immune system

XII Std Biology-Zoology Chapter-7 EM.indd 122 23/12/2022 12:39:57